



THE ASK

Alpha Hours

Four decisions to launch Alpha Hours in New York on October 19, 2026: the Head, the Operations and Admin VP, the New York guide team, and a \$365K launch that returns about \$1.1M in its first session.

PREPARED BY

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DATE

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STATUS

Draft for review

AT A GLANCE

Head

Nancy Wisniewski Torvund at \$400K, owning the P&L, held to plan fill, site profit and re-enrollment.

VP Ops

Operations and Admin VP at \$200K, remote, hired in September before the first family signs up.

13 guides

one per ten seats at \$50K part-time, plus two Lead Guides and a coordinator, hired to sold seats.

\$365K

to launch and run Session 2: the \$141K one-time budget plus the Head and VP from September 1 to December 18.

\$1.12M

Session 2 site profit on the plan case, 3.1x the investment inside the first session.

\$28.2M

Year 1 net on the plan, leaving Session 5 at an \$82M run rate. Every later step is paid from the session before it.

Four decisions to launch Alpha Hours in New York on October 19, 2026: name the Head, approve the Operations and Admin VP, approve the New York guide team, and fund a \$365K launch that returns about \$1.1M in its first session.

01

The ask in one paragraph

I am asking Alpha to approve four things by September 1. Name me Head of Alpha Hours at \$400,000, owning the P&L. Approve one Operations and Admin VP at \$200,000, remote, hired in September before the first family signs up. Approve the New York site team: two Lead Guides, one Campus Coordinator, and up to 13 guides at one guide per ten seats, hired to sold seats. Fund the launch: a \$141K one-time budget plus the central team from September 1 through December 18, about \$365K in total. Session 2 on the plan case collects \$1.40M before it opens and produces \$1.12M of site profit, about three times the investment, inside the first session. Everything after New York is paid from the sessions before it.

02

Ask one: name me Head of Alpha Hours

The role. Head of Alpha Hours, \$400,000. Strategy, pricing, campus relationships, guide hiring and training, the rollout, and the full P&L. Full time, starting now: sales open the week of September 7, and the New York filing, the Lead Guide hires, and the training cohort all sit between today and October 19.

What I am held to. Reviewed every session on three numbers: plan fill (60 percent of seats in a campus's first session, 75 in its second, 90 in its third, full from its fourth), site profit, and session-over-session re-enrollment at or above 70 percent. Full-time Alpha enrollments are reported as the upside line, not the test. The plan is \$35.4M of revenue and \$28.2M net in Year 1, and I own that number.

Why me. I built and ran the admissions pipeline at Alpha New York: the families, the lists, the buildings, the guides, the objections. The Hamptons program sold 174 paid registrations at \$4,500 a week with one price objection; that is the price and the buyer Alpha Hours is built on.

The 1,000-plus HubSpot families from that outreach are the first Session 2 list, and I already have them. The New York campuses, the Lead Guide candidates, and the parent networks in the Financial District are relationships I hold today.

03

Ask two: approve the Operations and Admin VP

The role. Operations and Admin VP, \$200,000, remote. Registration end to end (sign-ups, lane tagging, cohort placement, waitlists, repricing, roster handoff), compliance filings and insurance, host-campus agreements, central procurement (laptops, supplies, snacks, Emporium inventory), and weekly reporting by cohort and lane.

Why in September, not later. Between the first week of September and October 19, Alpha Hours registers 312 to 520 families, files the New York exemption and legal work, puts the payments and roster stack live, orders devices, snacks, and Emporium stock for two buildings, and runs a two-week training cohort. In November the Connecticut and Massachusetts filings go in and Greenwich and Boston hire. By February there are nine campuses in four states. That is a full-time operations job from day one. Without this hire, the Head is the registrar.

Operations support (\$100,000) is added under the VP as the footprint grows, inside the \$875K central team line already in the Year 1 plan. It is not part of the Session 2 ask.

04

Ask three: approve the New York guide team

One guide per ten seats. The same guide team serves all four cohorts, so one guide covers ten seats and up to 40 enrolled students. Guides are hired to sold seats, so no room opens understaffed and no room carries guides it has not sold.

Role	Count	Compensation	When
Lead Guide, 180 Maiden Lane	1	\$75,000	Hired by September 21
Lead Guide, 156 William Street	1	\$75,000	Hired by September 21
Campus Coordinator (shared by both buildings)	1	\$50,000, 50 percent role	Hired by September 21
Guides, 180 Maiden Lane (100 seats)	Up to 10	\$50,000 each, part-time	Hired to sold seats, September 21 to October 2
Guides, 156 William Street (30 seats)	Up to 3	\$50,000 each, part-time	Hired to sold seats, September 21 to October 2

On the plan case, Session 2 opens with 312 enrolled and 8 guides on payroll, \$80K of guide cost for the session. At capacity, 520 enrolled and 13 guides, \$130K. A guide works about 21 hours a week: four weekday blocks from 3:30 to 6:15 and a Saturday. Pay is weekly, two weeks in arrears, for every role.

Training. Every guide completes the Alpha Hours training program before running a room: two paid weeks, October 5 to 16, shadowing at Alpha New York plus an AI-first asynchronous course. The two paid weeks for 13 guides and 2 Lead Guides are the \$29K training line in the launch budget. While New York runs, Greenwich and Boston train their guides in the New York rooms.

Annual cost at capacity. Guides \$650K, Lead Guides \$150K, Coordinator \$50K, plus facility, insurance, and showcase events, about \$976K a year for both buildings against \$11.7M of revenue.

Ask four: the money

What it costs to launch Session 2

Item	Basis	Cost
Guide training cohort	13 guides and 2 Lead Guides, two paid weeks before launch	\$29K
State exemption filing and legal	New York	\$15K
Launch marketing	New York, sold to the whole city	\$40K
Loaner device pool	20 percent of 130 seats at \$600	\$16K
Insurance deposits	Two buildings	\$8K
Emporium opening inventory	\$25 a seat	\$3K
Registration and payments stack	Stripe, HubSpot, roster tooling	\$30K
One-time launch budget		\$141K
Central team, September 1 to December 18	Head and VP, fully loaded, seven weeks before launch and nine weeks of Session 2, paid weekly two weeks in arrears	\$225K
Total investment to launch and run Session 2		About \$365K

Session 2's own operating cost (Timeback, the motivation model, snacks, supplies, showcase, processing, marketing at \$435 a child; guides at \$10,000 each for the session; the two buildings' fixed cost of \$65K for the session) is about \$0.28M on the plan case. It is paid across the nine weeks from revenue collected before day one, so it is not part of the ask.

When the cash goes out and comes back

- **September 1 to October 19.** Cash out before the first tuition dollar is about \$210K: the \$141K launch budget and about \$70K of Head and VP pay. Pay runs weekly, two weeks in arrears, so five of the seven pre-launch weeks are paid out by October 19 and the rest lands after tuition is in. Sales open in September; the \$500 deposit on each sign-up lands the same day, \$156K on the plan case. Net exposure before launch is about \$55K.
- **Before October 19.** The balance of every family's \$4,500 is due before day one. On the plan case \$1.40M is collected before the first block runs. At capacity, \$2.34M.

- **October 19 to December 18.** Guides are paid weekly, two weeks in arrears: the two training weeks land October 19 and 26, after tuition is in, and the seven session weeks land November 2 through January 1. Timeback is billed per session, fixed cost runs monthly. About \$0.28M goes out against \$1.40M already in, and the last two weeks of payroll, about \$50K of central and guide pay, lands after December 18 from cash collected in October. Re-enrollment for Session 3 opens the week of November 9, so Session 3 deposits arrive before Session 2 ends.

The program never needs working capital from the school after the launch budget, and no lease, build-out, or capital purchase is required. The buildings are already paid for.

The return

Case	Enrolled	Session 2 revenue	Session 2 site profit	Net after the \$365K
Floor (25 percent fill)	130	\$0.59M	\$0.42M	\$0.06M
Plan (60 percent fill)	312	\$1.40M	\$1.12M	\$0.76M
Capacity (100 percent fill)	520	\$2.34M	\$1.92M	\$1.55M

Even the floor case, every cohort a quarter full, pays back the launch inside the session. On the plan case the \$365K comes back three times over by December 18, and the two buildings leave Session 2 running at a \$7.0M annual revenue rate on their way to \$11.7M.

What Session 2 buys after Session 2

- **Session 3 (January 4, 2027).** Greenwich (80 seats) and Boston (40 and 100) open. Their launch cost, about \$200K, is paid from Session 2 revenue. Five campuses, 350 seats, \$31.5M run rate at capacity.
- **Session 4 (February 24, 2027).** Chicago (517), Miami (150), Palm Beach (60), Miami Beach (50). About \$400K of launch cost, paid from Session 3. Nine campuses, 1,127 seats, 4,508 enrolled, \$101.4M run rate, \$83.5M net at capacity.
- **Year 1 (Sessions 2 to 5).** Plan \$35.4M revenue, \$28.2M net after the full \$875K central team, leaving Session 5 at an \$82M run rate. Capacity \$49.2M / \$39.9M. Floor \$12.3M / \$8.6M. Total

- one-time launch cost across the year is about \$0.74M, all of it paid from the sessions before it. The \$365K in this document is the only money that comes from Alpha.
- **Session 1, Fall 2027.** National launch, about 40 campuses, 11,908 children on Timeback after school, \$268M revenue, about \$216M net at capacity.

The downside

Break-even is 15 students at 180 Maiden Lane and 12 at 156 William Street, 27 in total against 312 on the plan. The cohort floor decision on October 5 closes any cohort under ten seats two weeks out, so an empty cohort never opens. The most any site can lose is seven weeks of payroll. There is no lease, no build-out, and no device fleet to write off; the loaner pool is \$16K.

06

What I am held to

Checkpoint	Date	The test
Cohort floor decision	October 5, 2026	Every cohort at ten seats or more, or it does not open
Session 2 opens	October 19, 2026	312 enrolled on the plan, 130 seats sold to 60 percent
Week-3 checkpoint	Week of November 2, 2026	Fill at or above 40 percent, neither building below its floor. Passing releases Greenwich and Boston for Session 3
Session 3 re-enrollment opens	Week of November 9, 2026	Target at or above 70 percent; 60 percent is the release test for Chicago and Florida
Session 2 closes	December 18, 2026	\$1.12M site profit on the plan; report by cohort, lane, and building

Weekly reporting by cohort and lane. Every session reviewed on revenue, site profit, and re-enrollment. Full-time Alpha enrollments reported as the upside line.

07

Dates

- **Today, August 28.** Head full time on Alpha Hours.

- **September 1.** Decision. VP starts. New York exemption filing goes in.
- **Week of September 7.** Sales open to the whole city: the Hamptons families, the HubSpot list, the Financial District parent networks.
- **September 21.** Lead Guides and Coordinator in seat. Guide hiring against sold seats through October 2.
- **October 5.** Cohort floor decision. Training cohort begins.
- **October 19.** Session 2 opens, 180 Maiden Lane and 156 William Street.
- **Week of November 2.** Week-3 checkpoint. Greenwich and Boston released.
- **December 18.** Session 2 closes with the AlphaTest Showcase. Session 3 opens January 4.

08

The decision

THE DECISION

Approve four things by September 1: Nancy Wisniewski Torvund as Head of Alpha Hours at \$400K, an Operations and Admin VP at \$200K, the New York site team of two Lead Guides, a coordinator and up to 13 guides hired to sold seats, and a \$365K launch that Session 2 returns three times over before December 18.

Alpha's learning-speed and test-score figures cited throughout are Alpha's own internal data and are not independently audited.